FEDIAF input to Proposal for Regulation on the welfare of dogs and cats and their traceability

EC proposal	FEDIAF amendment	Justification
Article 11, point 2(b) feed in sufficient quantity and quality to meet the physiological, nutritional and metabolic needs and satiety of the dogs and cats, as part of a diet adapted to the age, breed, category, activity level, and health status of the dogs and cats	**Article 11, point 2(b)** feed in sufficient quantity and quality to meet the physiological, nutritional and metabolic needs ~~and satiety~~ of the dogs and cats[1], as part of a diet adapted to the age, breed, category, activity level, and health status of the dogs and cats; feed is offered in a designate cleaned container	Individual satiety may vary and therefore we recommend removing this point to not encourage overfeeding. FEDIAF nutritional guidelines provides clear and usable recommendations for the preparation of complete* pet food (feed) for dogs and cats. These guidelines can support those in scope to meet the obligations of the proposed Regulation. * As per Regulation 767/2009 'complete feed' means compound feed which, by reason of its composition, is sufficient for a daily ration; The FEDIAF Nutritional guidelines are recognised by the European Commission being referenced in Regulation (EU) 2020/354 establishing a list of intended uses of feed intended for particular nutritional purposes and repealing Directive 2008/38/EC. The FEDIAF nutritional guidelines are prepared by FEDIAF together with the FEDIAF Scientific Advisory Board. The Scientific advisory board is composed of board certified veterinary nutritionist with expertise in dog and cat nutrition. In additions, it is recommended to indicate that the feed is provided in a suitable container to maintain the quality of the feed.

Article 11, point 2(b) adult cats and dogs shall be fed twice a day;	**Article 11, point 2(b)** adult cats and dogs shall be fed ~~twice a day~~ daily to meet their energy and nutritional requirements[1];	Feeding frequency of dogs and cats may vary. FEDIAF nutritional guidelines provides clear and usable recommendations for the preparation of complete pet food (feed) for dogs and cats.
Article 11, point 2(c) feed free of substances which may cause suffering;	**Article 11, point 2(c)** ~~feed free of substances which may cause suffering;~~ feed compliant with appropriate European Union legislation	Union law indicates the requirements in order to place safe feed on the market e.g. Regulation (EC) No 183/2005 laying down requirements for feed hygiene Regulation (EC) No 767/2009 on the placing on the market and use of feed.
Annex 1 , point 1.1 (a) The operator shall implement the following feeding frequencies: (a) adult cats and dogs shall be fed twice a day	**Annex 1 , point 1.1 (a)** The operator shall implement the following feeding frequencies: (a) adult cats and dogs shall be fed ~~twice a day~~ daily to meet their energy and nutritional requirements[1];	Feeding frequency of dogs and cats may vary. FEDIAF nutritional guidelines provides for the preparation of complete pet food (feed) for dogs and cats.
Annex 1 , point 1.1 (b) Pregnant bitches and queens shall have ad libitum access to feed;	**Article 11, point 1.1(b)** Pregnant and lactating bitches and queens shall ~~have ad libitum access to feed~~ be feed to meet their increased physiological and nutritional needs[1].	It is not appropriate to feed pregnant bitches *ab libitum* throughout pregnancy (Greco, 2014; Fascetti and Delaney, 2023). Greco DS. Pediatric nutrition. Vet Clin North Am Small Anim Pract. 2014 Mar;44(2):265-73. doi:10.1016/j.cvsm.2013.11.001. Fascetti AJ and Delaney SJ. Chapter 7: Feeding the Healthy Dog and Cat. Applied Veterinary Clinical Nutrition. Edited by Larsen JA, and Villaverde C. Wiley, 2023. Pg 106-135.
Annex 1 , point 1.1 (c) puppies under 8 weeks of age shall be fed at least 5 times a day;	**Article 11, point 1.1(c)** c) puppies under 8 weeks of age ~~shall be fed at least 5~~	The feeding schedule for puppies may vary by individual. Experts indicate puppies should be fed at least twice daily

[1] FEDIAF Nutritional Guidelines provides nutritional recommendations for the preparation of complete dog and cat food.

	~~times a day~~ shall be fed several meals per day;	however some may require three or more meals (Fascetti and Delaney, 2023). Fascetti AJ and Delaney SJ. Chapter 7: Feeding the Healthy Dog and Cat. Applied Veterinary Clinical Nutrition. Edited by Larsen JA, and Villaverde C. Wiley, 2023. Pg 106-135.
Annex 1 , point 1.1 (d) kittens under 12 weeks of age shall be fed at least 4 times a day	**Annex 1 , point 1.1 (d)** c) kittens under 12 weeks of age shall be fed ~~shall be fed at least 4 times a day~~ shall be several meals per day;	The feeding schedule for kittens may vary by individual. Experts do not indicate a specific number of meals per day. (Fascetti and Delaney, 2023). Fascetti AJ and Delaney SJ. Chapter 7: Feeding the Healthy Dog and Cat. Applied Veterinary Clinical Nutrition. Edited by Larsen JA, and Villaverde C. Wiley, 2023. Pg 106-135.